

Ways of Earning

Earning Money

2026

Preliminary Mathematics Standard

Salaries

Wages & Penalty Rates

Commission & Other Earnings

Pay Period Conversions

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Definition: A fixed annual amount paid regardless of hours worked.

Key Formula:

$$\text{Weekly Pay} = \frac{\text{Annual Salary}}{52} \qquad \text{Fortnightly Pay} = \frac{\text{Annual Salary}}{26}$$

Example: Jordan earns \$74 000 p.a. Find the weekly pay.

$$\text{Weekly Pay} = \frac{74\,000}{52} \approx \$1423.08$$

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Wages & Penalty Rates

Definition: Wages are paid per hour worked.

Time	Typical Rate
Normal hours	$1 \times$ hourly rate
Overtime	$1.5 \times$ (time-and-a-half)
Double time	$2 \times$ hourly rate
Public holiday	$2.5 \times$ hourly rate

Example: Maya earns \$22/hr. She works 8 hrs on a public holiday.

$$\text{Pay} = 8 \times 22 \times 2.5 = \$440$$

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Commission

Flat Commission:

$$\text{Earnings} = \text{Rate} \times \text{Total Sales}$$

Sliding Scale Commission: Different rates apply to different sales brackets.

Example (Sliding Scale):

- 5% on first \$10 000
- 8% on amounts over \$10 000

Sales = \$15 000:

$$= 0.05 \times 10\,000 + 0.08 \times 5\,000 = 500 + 400 = \$900$$

Piecework, Royalties & Government Payments

Piecework: Paid per item produced.

$$\text{Earnings} = \text{Rate per item} \times \text{Number of items}$$

Royalties: A percentage of sales revenue paid to a creator.

$$\text{Royalty} = \text{Royalty Rate} \times \text{Revenue}$$

Government Payments: Fixed or means-tested payments (e.g. Youth Allowance, JobSeeker). Read the given table/rate and multiply by the relevant period.

Sole Trader:

$$\text{Net Earnings} = \text{Revenue} - \text{Expenses}$$

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Weekly, Fortnightly, Monthly & Yearly Earnings

Convert from	To	Multiply by
Weekly	Fortnightly	$\times 2$
Weekly	Monthly	$\times 52 \div 12$
Weekly	Yearly	$\times 52$
Fortnightly	Yearly	$\times 26$
Monthly	Yearly	$\times 12$

Example: Weekly wage = \$950

$$\text{Annual} = 950 \times 52 = \$49\,400$$

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Definition: An additional payment (usually 17.5%) on top of normal pay during annual leave.

Formula:

$$\text{Leave Loading} = 17.5\% \times \text{Eligible Normal Pay}$$

$$\text{Total Holiday Pay} = \text{Normal Pay} + \text{Leave Loading}$$

Example: Sam's normal pay for 4 weeks leave = \$3 200.

$$\text{Leave Loading} = 0.175 \times 3\,200 = \$560$$

$$\text{Total} = 3\,200 + 560 = \$3\,760$$

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Complete all questions from *Earning Money — Ways of Earning*.